

File Path Traversal

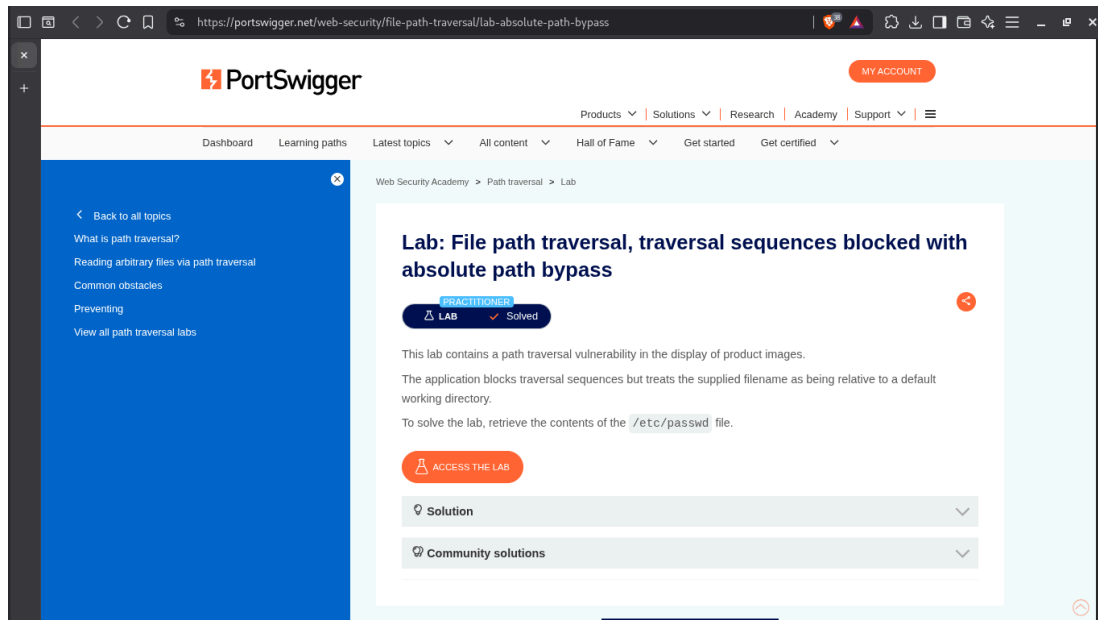
Name: Matyas Abreham

IDNO: CTC-207-26

Lab 8: File Path Traversal, Traversal Sequences Blocked with Absolute Path Bypass

Objective

The application blocks ../ traversal sequences but treats the filename as relative to a default working directory. The goal is to retrieve /etc/passwd by bypassing this restriction.

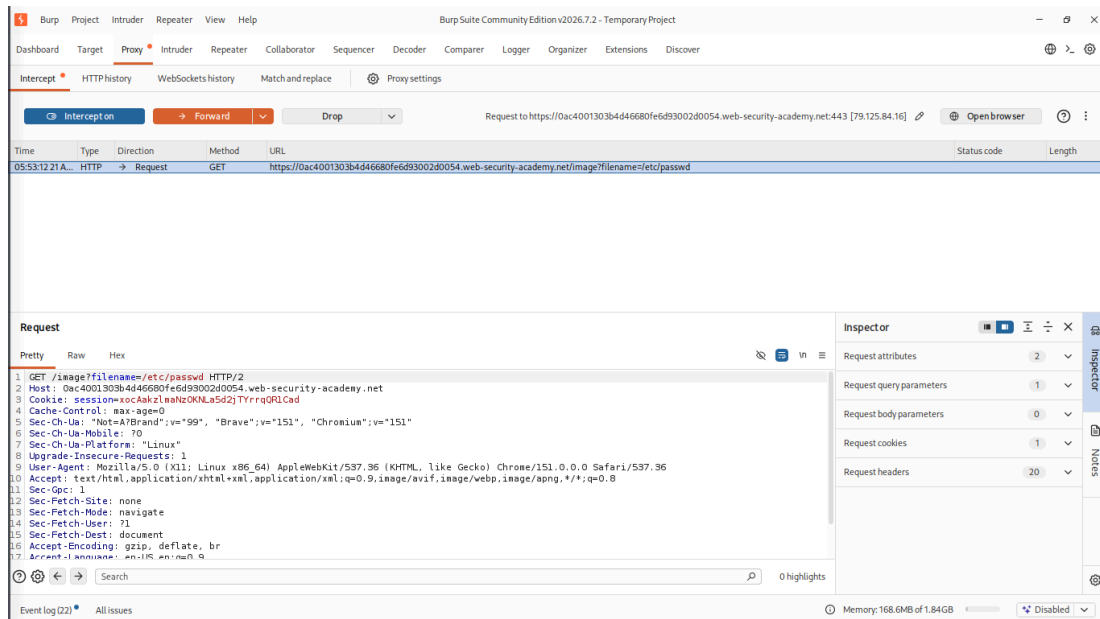


Lab description page (PortSwigger).

Steps

The standard traversal payload (../../etc/passwd) was blocked by the application's filter. Since the app treats the supplied filename as relative to a fixed base directory, an absolute path was supplied instead, skipping the need for ../ sequences entirely:

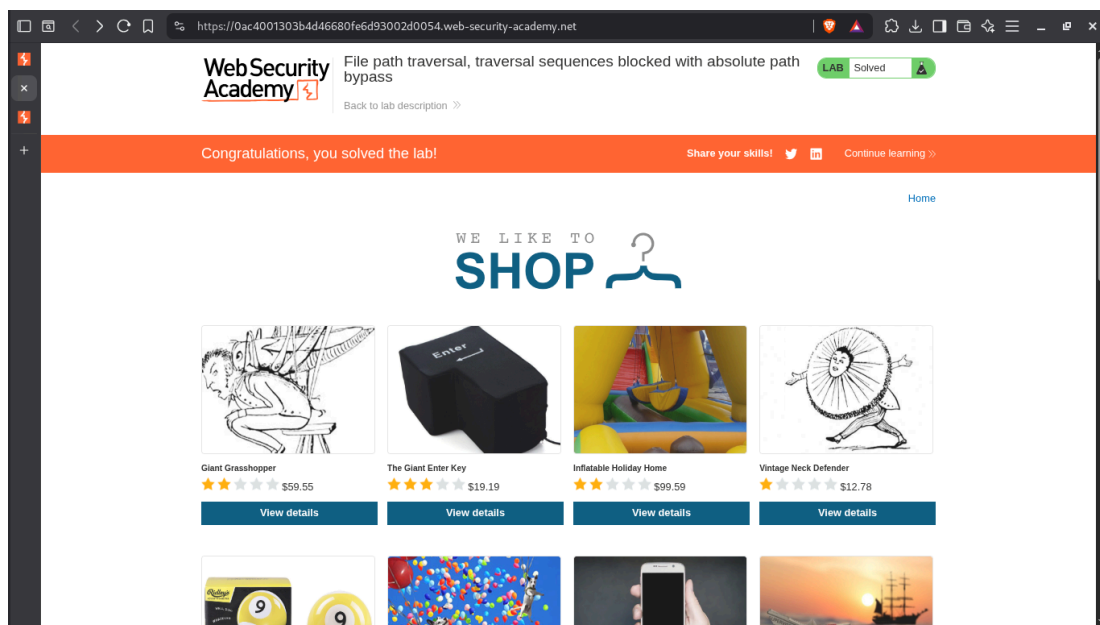
```
GET /image?filename=/etc/passwd
```



Burp Proxy intercepting the request with the absolute path payload.

Result

The response returned the contents of /etc/passwd, confirming the absolute path bypassed the traversal filter.



Lab marked as Solved.

Vulnerability

The filter only blocked relative traversal sequences (../) but failed to reject absolute file paths, which some file-handling APIs treat as taking priority over the base directory.